

Gautam Velpula

VP, Product Engineering

Platform Modernization • AI-Enabled Products • Global Engineering at Scale

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Executive Summary

Technology executive with 15+ years of experience leading global product engineering organizations delivering mission-critical platforms at scale. Proven track record driving portfolio transformation—product convergence, platform modernization, API-led integration, and new product incubation. Deep experience partnering with Product Management to set strategy, prioritize roadmaps, and deliver measurable business outcomes. Currently leading AI-enabled product capabilities including generative AI, intelligent automation, and agentic experiences with responsible AI governance. Combines engineering depth, product instincts, and executive presence to build high-performing teams across global, matrixed organizations.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

- Owned end-to-end engineering strategy and architectural direction for a portfolio of customer-facing product lines across digital ordering, payments, subscriptions, and marketing technology—serving as the single technical authority across the enterprise.
- Partnered closely with Product leadership to shape roadmap, influence prioritization, and bring new product capabilities to market, ensuring technology decisions accelerated customer outcomes and business results.
- Led a major **portfolio transformation**: converged 7 independent brand platforms into a unified, API-led architecture—reducing development costs, accelerating feature delivery, and improving long-term platform sustainability.
- Drove **platform modernization** from monolithic legacy systems to a microservices and event-driven architecture, standardizing service contracts, CI/CD pipelines, and integration patterns across the portfolio.
- Led the portfolio's **AI strategy**: drove practical applications of generative AI, intelligent automation, and agentic experiences across customer-facing products and internal workflows.
- Defined architectural patterns, guardrails, and governance frameworks for **responsible AI** in production, partnering with security and compliance to balance innovation with risk management.
- Designed and delivered payments platform integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets, tokenization, and modern checkout across brands.
- Incubated and delivered a new subscription product supporting recurring-revenue business models, including hands-on technical intervention during a critical system failure.
- Established strong operating rigor across delivery, architecture, quality, security, and reliability—reducing time-to-market by approximately 40% and improving system uptime by approximately 30%.
- Built and led a high-performing organization of principal and lead architects, raising technical standards and growing leadership bench strength through mentoring and targeted development.
- Served as a senior technology voice with stakeholders across business, product, engineering, and customer-facing teams—communicating trade-offs and investment decisions in clear, outcome-focused language.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Led multi-million-dollar digital transformation, platform modernization, and product engineering engagements for Fortune 500 clients delivering mission-critical B2B and B2C SaaS products at scale.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise assessment of a legacy platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture, API-led integration strategy, and modernization roadmap.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading technology provider, ensuring continuity of mission-critical services throughout the transition.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, partnering with Product and business leadership to translate strategy into actionable engineering roadmaps.
- Directed cross-functional, globally distributed teams across engineering, architecture, product, and design.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Achieved approximately 95% client satisfaction and repeat business by consistently delivering measurable customer and business outcomes.
- Mentored delivery leaders and principals, building leadership bench strength and scaling organizational delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations of mission-critical workflow software for Fortune 500 clients.
- Built and led a high-performing global team across multiple geographies, with end-to-end accountability from pre-sales through post-implementation.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, aligning technology delivery with business objectives and leading through organizational change.
- Served as the senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance and engineering direction.
- Built leadership bench strength through recruiting, mentoring, succession planning, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology & Platform Expertise

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions), Google Cloud Platform, Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture: Microservices, event-driven systems, API-led integration, platform convergence, cloud-native patterns

AI/ML: Generative AI, LLM integration, agentic AI architectures, intelligent automation, responsible AI governance

Engineering Practices: CI/CD, DevOps, observability/SRE (Splunk, GA4, Firebase), secure SDLC, privacy

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB, Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Core Strengths

Product Engineering Leadership • Portfolio Transformation & Convergence • AI-Enabled Product Strategy • Platform Modernization & API-Led Integration • Global Team Building • Product Partnership & Roadmap Influence • Executive Presence & Stakeholder Management • Operating Rigor & Engineering Excellence

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology George Mason University, Fairfax, VA	<i>2007 – 2009</i>
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science Osmania University, Hyderabad, India	<i>2002 – 2006</i>